CORE FALSE BELIEF #14 · THE WORLD & THE FUTURE

"Things will always go badly."

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

This belief often follows a long run of hardship: repeated losses, chronic illness, financial struggles, or a childhood where good things rarely lasted. When disappointment comes again and again, the mind learns to expect it, partly to avoid being caught off guard. Over time hopelessness can feel like realism, and good things get dismissed as flukes.

What Scripture teaches

Scripture does not deny that life brings trouble, but it insists that trouble is not the final word. God told His people in exile that He had plans to give them a future and a hope. Weeping may stay the night, but joy comes in the morning. God promises to do new things, even making a way in the wilderness. Paul wrote that God works all things together for the good of those who love Him. Bad seasons are real, but they are seasons, and God is at work in them.

> *"For I know the plans I have for you, declares the LORD, plans to prosper you and not to harm you, to give you a future and a hope"* (Jeremiah 29:11).

Also see

> "And we know that God works all things together for the good of those who love Him, who are called according to His purpose" (Romans 8:28).

> "Because of the loving devotion of the LORD we are not consumed, for His mercies never fail. They are new every morning; great is Your faithfulness!" (Lamentations 3:22–23).

> "For His anger is fleeting, but His favor lasts a lifetime. Weeping may stay the night, but joy comes in the morning" (Psalm 30:5).

> "Behold, I am about to do something new; even now it is coming. Do you not see it? Indeed, I will make a way in the wilderness and streams in the desert" (Isaiah 43:19).

Common self-statements

- Nothing ever works out for me.
- As soon as things get better, something will ruin it.
- Why hope? It never turns out.
- My life is just one bad thing after another.
- Good things don't last.
- It will always be like this.

Common logical errors

- Fortune telling: Predicting that the future will be as bad as the past.
- Overgeneralization: Using "always" and "never" about my life.
- Mental filter: Seeing only what goes wrong and overlooking what goes right.
- Discounting the positive: Calling good things luck or temporary.

Challenging questions

- Is it true that things always go badly, or only often?

- What has gone well, even in small ways, this past year?
- What season of my life was better than I expected?
- What does God say about my future?
- Am I protecting myself from disappointment by expecting the worst?
- What would hope look like today?

Truth summary

> I have been through many hard things, and more may come. But "always" is not true. Good things have happened, and God has promised a future and a hope. Hard seasons do not last forever, and God is at work even now.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Hopeless
- Hardship
- Plans
- Thinking, Healthy
- Joy

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Trouble/Hardship
- Depression

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Glorious Unfolding — Steven Curtis Chapman
God's story continues beyond a painful or confusing chapter.

All Things New — Steven Curtis Chapman
God's renewing work offers hope beyond failure, decay, and loss.

Even If — MercyMe
Trust in God need not depend on receiving the particular miracle we want.

Because He Lives — Bill and Gloria Gaither
This older favorite grounds courage for tomorrow in Christ's resurrection.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "Things will always go badly"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"Things will always go badly." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ Is it true things always go badly?
- ☐ What has gone well this year?
- ☐ When was life better than I expected?
- ☐ What does God say about my future?
- ☐ Am I expecting the worst to protect myself?
- ☐ What would hope look like today?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ God has plans to give me a future and a hope.
- ☐ Joy comes in the morning.
- ☐ His mercies are new every morning.
- ☐ Hard seasons are seasons.
- ☐ God is doing something new.
- ☐ Good things are real, not just luck.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ **Jeremiah 29:11**
  "For I know the plans I have for you, declares the LORD, plans to prosper you and not to harm you, to give you a future and a hope."
- ☐ **Psalm 30:5**
  "For His anger is fleeting, but His favor lasts a lifetime. Weeping may stay the night, but joy comes in the morning."
- ☐ **Isaiah 43:19**
  "Behold, I am about to do something new; even now it is coming. Do you not see it? Indeed, I will make a way in the wilderness and streams in the desert."

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- ☐ Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- ☐ Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ What went right today: Each evening, write three things that went right today, even small ones.
- ☐ My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Jeremiah 29:11 becomes: "Tom can write: "God knows the plans He has for me. He is giving me a future and a hope.""
- ☐ Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ Reading: The "Hopeless" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

Choose steps you can do safely. If this belief comes with hopelessness or thoughts of ending your life, call or text 988 (the Suicide & Crisis Lifeline), or call 911 in an emergency. You do not have to carry this alone.

- ☐ Keep a "good things" journal. Each night for two weeks, write three good things that happened. Read the whole list at the end.
- ☐ Remember a turnaround. Write about a time something you dreaded turned out better than expected.
- ☐ Plan one good thing. Schedule one small thing you can look forward to this week.
- ☐ Get help for lasting hopelessness. If hopelessness is heavy or constant, talk with a doctor, pastor, or counselor.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "Things will always go badly": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Something that went right
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~Things will always go badly.~~

THE TRUTH

_____

_____

GOD'S WORD

_____

_____

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, I have come to expect the worst. Thank You that You have plans to give me a future and a hope. Open my eyes to the good You are doing, and give me hope for tomorrow. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.

CORE FALSE BELIEF #15 · THE WORLD & THE FUTURE

"The world is unsafe."

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

This belief often comes from real danger: abuse, violence, a frightening accident, a crime, a natural disaster, or growing up in a chaotic home. Constant news of tragedy can strengthen it. After danger, the body stays on alert, scanning for threats. That alertness helped us survive, but when it never shuts off, it can keep us anxious, isolated, and unable to enjoy life.

What Scripture teaches

Scripture is honest that the world has dangers; Jesus said that in this world we will have trouble. But He added that He has overcome the world. The psalmist found shelter in the shadow of the Almighty and could lie down and sleep in peace because the Lord made him dwell in safety. The name of the Lord is a strong tower. God does not promise that nothing bad will ever happen, but He promises His presence, and our ultimate safety rests in Him.

> *"He who dwells in the shelter of the Most High will abide in the shadow of the Almighty. I will say to the LORD, 'You are my refuge and my fortress, my God, in whom I trust.'"* (Psalm 91:1–2).

Also see

> "I have told you these things so that in Me you may have peace. In the world you will have tribulation. But take courage; I have overcome the world!" (John 16:33).

> "I will lie down and sleep in peace, for You alone, O LORD, make me dwell in safety" (Psalm 4:8).

> "The name of the LORD is a strong tower; the righteous run to it and are safe" (Proverbs 18:10).

> "You will keep in perfect peace the steadfast of mind, because he trusts in You" (Isaiah 26:3).

Common self-statements

- Something bad could happen at any moment.
- I have to stay on guard.
- It's not safe to go out.
- People are dangerous.
- If I relax, I'll get hurt.
- Nowhere is safe.

Common logical errors

- Overgeneralization: Deciding that because danger happened once, it is everywhere.
- Catastrophizing: Treating unlikely dangers as certain.
- Mental filter: Focusing on threats and overlooking signs of safety.
- Emotional reasoning: Believing I am in danger because I feel afraid.

Challenging questions

- What happened that taught me the world is unsafe?

- Is that danger present now, or am I reacting to the past?
- What reasonable steps keep me safe, and which ones are excessive?
- Where have I been safe recently?
- What does God promise about His protection and presence?
- What could I enjoy if I felt a little safer?

Truth summary

> There are real dangers in the world, and I have been hurt before. But I am not in danger every moment. I can take sensible precautions and then rest, because God is my refuge. He has overcome the world, and I can find peace in Him.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Refuge/Safety
- Protection
- Fear
- Peace
- Trust

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Anxiety/Worry/Fear
- Suffering

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

> Overcoming Anxiety · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Whom Shall I Fear — Chris Tomlin
God's presence provides courage without requiring a life free of difficulty.

Battle Belongs — Phil Wickham
Bring fear and uncertainty to God rather than carrying the outcome alone.

Same Power — Jeremy Camp
God's power challenges the belief that evil or fear has the final authority.

Turn Your Eyes Upon Jesus — Reawaken Hymns
This classic hymn directs attention to Christ when fear or earthly concerns dominate.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "The world is unsafe"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"The world is unsafe." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What taught me the world is unsafe?
- ☐ Is that danger present now?
- ☐ Which precautions are sensible and which are excessive?
- ☐ Where have I been safe recently?
- ☐ What does God promise about His protection?
- ☐ What could I enjoy if I felt safer?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ God is my refuge and fortress.
- ☐ Jesus has overcome the world.
- ☐ I can lie down in peace.
- ☐ Feeling afraid is not the same as being in danger.
- ☐ I can take wise steps and then rest.
- ☐ The name of the Lord is a strong tower.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ **Psalm 91:1–2**
  "He who dwells in the shelter of the Most High will abide in the shadow of the Almighty. I will say to the LORD, 'You are my refuge and my fortress, my God, in whom I trust.'"
- ☐ **John 16:33**
  "I have told you these things so that in Me you may have peace. In the world you will have tribulation. But take courage; I have overcome the world!"
- ☐ **Psalm 4:8**
  "I will lie down and sleep in peace, for You alone, O LORD, make me dwell in safety."

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] Where I was safe today: Each evening, write the places and moments you were safe today.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Psalm 91:1–2 becomes: "Karen can write: "The Lord is my refuge and my fortress. I can rest in His shelter today.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Refuge/Safety" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Anxiety audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

Choose steps you can do safely. If this belief comes with hopelessness or thoughts of ending your life, call or text 988 (the Suicide & Crisis Lifeline), or call 911 in an emergency. You do not have to carry this alone.

- [ ] Separate past from present. Write what happened in the past that frightened you. Then write what is different about your situation now.
- [ ] Take one brave step. Choose one place or activity you avoid out of fear that is actually safe, and do it this week with support if needed.
- [ ] Limit the news. Choose a set time for news once a day instead of checking all day.
- [ ] Get help for trauma. If past danger still triggers strong fear, flashbacks, or nightmares, talk with a counselor trained to help.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "The world is unsafe": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	A moment I felt safe
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~The world is unsafe.~~

THE TRUTH

_____

_____

GOD'S WORD

_____

_____

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, I feel unsafe so much of the time. Thank You that You are my refuge and that Jesus has overcome the world. Calm my body and mind, give me wisdom to stay safe, and help me rest in Your shelter. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.

CORE FALSE BELIEF #16 · THE WORLD & THE FUTURE

“Something terrible is going to happen.”

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

A sense of coming doom often follows a sudden shock, such as an unexpected death, diagnosis, or accident, which teaches the mind that disaster can strike without warning. It can also grow in homes where parents were constantly worried, or where something bad really did happen often. Worry can feel like protection, as if expecting the worst could prevent it.

What Scripture teaches

Jesus told His followers not to worry about tomorrow, because each day has enough trouble of its own. Paul urged believers to bring every anxious thought to God in prayer with thanksgiving, and promised that God’s peace would guard their hearts and minds. The psalmist describes a person who does not fear bad news because his heart is steady, trusting in the Lord. Worry cannot add a single hour to life. God does not ask us to pretend bad things never happen; He asks us to trust Him with tomorrow.

> *“Therefore do not worry about tomorrow, for tomorrow will worry about itself. Today has enough trouble of its own”* (Matthew 6:34).

Also see

> “Be anxious for nothing, but in everything, by prayer and petition, with thanksgiving, present your requests to God. And the peace of God, which surpasses all understanding, will guard your hearts and your minds in Christ Jesus” (Philippians 4:6–7).

> “He does not fear bad news; his heart is steadfast, trusting in the LORD” (Psalm 112:7).

> “Who of you by worrying can add a single hour to his life?” (Matthew 6:27).

> “For God has not given us a spirit of fear, but of power, love, and self-control” (2 Timothy 1:7).

Common self-statements

- I just know something bad is coming.
- If I stop worrying, it will happen.
- Every phone call might be bad news.
- Things are too good; something will go wrong.
- I need to be prepared for the worst.
- I can’t shake this feeling of dread.

Common logical errors

- Fortune telling: Predicting disaster without evidence.
- Catastrophizing: Jumping from a small worry to the worst possible outcome.
- Emotional reasoning: Believing danger is coming because I feel dread.
- Magical thinking: Believing my worry somehow prevents bad things.

Challenging questions

- What evidence do I have that something terrible is about to happen?

- How many times have I felt this dread and nothing happened?
- Does my worrying actually prevent anything?
- If something hard did happen, how might God help me through it?
- What does Jesus say about tomorrow?
- What can I do today instead of worrying about tomorrow?

Truth summary

> Hard things can happen, and I cannot prevent every one. But this feeling of dread is not a prophecy, and worry does not protect me. God holds tomorrow. I can bring my fears to Him, live today, and trust Him to help me with whatever comes.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Anxiety/Worry
- Fear
- Peace
- Trust
- Thinking, Healthy

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Anxiety/Worry/Fear
- Thinking, Healthy

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

> Overcoming Anxiety · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Fear Is a Liar — Zach Williams
Examine fear-driven accusations rather than treating them as reliable truth.

Battle Belongs — Phil Wickham
Bring fear and uncertainty to God rather than carrying the outcome alone.

Already There — Casting Crowns
God's perspective extends beyond what we can currently understand.

Because He Lives — Bill and Gloria Gaither
This older favorite grounds courage for tomorrow in Christ's resurrection.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "Something terrible is going to happen"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"Something terrible is going to happen." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What evidence says something terrible is coming?
- ☐ How often has this dread come true?
- ☐ Does worrying prevent anything?
- ☐ How might God help me if something hard happened?
- ☐ What does Jesus say about tomorrow?
- ☐ What can I do today?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ Tomorrow will take care of itself.
- ☐ God's peace can guard my heart and mind.
- ☐ Dread is a feeling, not a prediction.
- ☐ Worry cannot add an hour to my life.
- ☐ God holds my future.
- ☐ I can live today.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ Matthew 6:34
  "Therefore do not worry about tomorrow, for tomorrow will worry about itself. Today has enough trouble of its own."
- ☐ Philippians 4:6–7
  "Be anxious for nothing, but in everything, by prayer and petition, with thanksgiving, present your requests to God. And the peace of God, which surpasses all understanding, will guard your hearts and your minds in Christ Jesus."
- ☐ Psalm 112:7
  "He does not fear bad news; his heart is steadfast, trusting in the LORD."

A verse I found myself: _____

_____

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] Fears and outcomes: Each day, write down any fear about something terrible happening. A week later, note whether it happened.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Matthew 6:34 becomes: "James can write: "I don't have to carry tomorrow today. God will be with me when it comes.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Anxiety/Worry" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Anxiety audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

Choose steps you can do safely. If this belief comes with hopelessness or thoughts of ending your life, call or text 988 (the Suicide & Crisis Lifeline), or call 911 in an emergency. You do not have to carry this alone.

- [ ] Test your predictions. Keep a list of the bad things you predict for two weeks. At the end, count how many actually happened.
- [ ] Set a worry time. Give yourself 15 minutes a day to write worries and pray over them. Outside that time, gently postpone worry.
- [ ] Pray it through. When dread rises, pray Philippians 4:6–7 aloud, naming each fear and thanking God for one thing.
- [ ] Get help for constant dread. If dread is constant or comes with panic attacks, talk with a doctor or counselor.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

What I learned: _____

The lie "Something terrible is going to happen": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	A fear that did not come true
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~Something terrible is going to happen.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, I am so often afraid that something terrible is coming. Thank You that You hold tomorrow. I give You my fears today. Guard my heart and mind with Your peace, and help me live this day with You. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.